



Scoreboard

Content Filtering Software

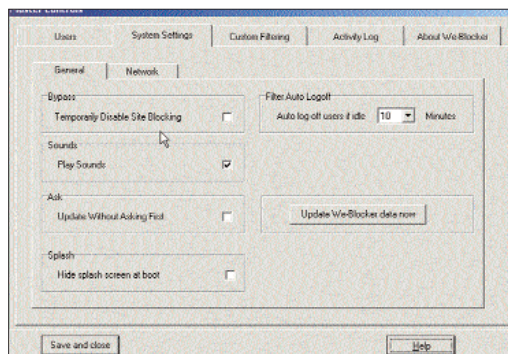
	Child Control 2006	ContentProtect	Cyber Patrol	CYBERSitter 9.0	iProtectYou Web Filter v7.10	Net Nanny	Optenet Web Filter	Parental Filter 0.24	We-Blocker 2.0
Site	www.salfeld.com	www.contentwatch.com	www.cyberpatrol.com	www.cybersitter.com	www.softforyou.com	www.netnanny.com	www.optenet.com	www.ecommsec.com	www.we-blocker.com
Features (Out of 20)	14.4	11.2	12.2	16	13.2	11	11.8	12.4	10.6
Blocking									
URL Blocking	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Image Blocking	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Chat Filter	✗	✗	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Reporting									
E-mail reports	✓	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Logs	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
Security									
Password Protection	✓	✓	✓	✓-Paid version only	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Task Manager Removal	✓	✗	✗	✓-Paid version only	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗
Overall Security	4	2	2	5	2	3	3	4	3
Other Browser Support									
Firefox	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗
Opera	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✓	✓
License	30	14	14	10	14	15	15	Free	Free
Ease Of Use (Out of 10)	6.96	6.97	6.42	8.12	7.95	6.22	6.28	6.65	8.07
Download Size	5.23	5.15	12	2.36	2.57	22.8	17.7	3.03	2.41
Setup	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
Configuration	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	3	4
Performance (Out of 50)	24	26	28	44	24	18	18	24	16
Normal Setting									
Sites Blocked (Out of 5)	4	5	5	5	4	3	3	4	4
Images Blocked (Out of 5)	0	0	0	4	0	0	0	0	0
Words Blocked (Out of 5)	4	3	4	4	4	3	3	4	0
Paranoid Setting									
Sites Blocked (Out of 5)	5	NA	5	5	NA	5	NA	NA	4
Images Blocked (Out of 5)	0	NA	0	4	NA	5	NA	NA	0
Words Blocked (Out of 5)	5	NA	4	4	NA	5	NA	NA	0
Price (Out of 20)	10.03	7.50	7.51	7.51	8.58	7.51	7.69	20.00	20.00
Overall Score (out of 100)	55.39	51.67	54.13	75.63	53.73	42.73	43.77	63.05	54.67

promptly started up again, so there's a decent level of security here.

That's where the security stops, however! After the installation, I found that it was only working with IE and not with Firefox and Opera. I rebooted the computer, and then found that it started blocking access in Opera, but still nothing in Firefox.

I soon found that this was because the application acts as a local proxy server, and you have to set the appropriate settings in the browsers. However, this means that if your child knows anything about proxy servers, or even stumbles upon the settings, disabling the proxy server is as good as the software not being installed! This is unforgivable, but we cannot complain because you're not being charged to use this software. It blocked content pretty well, but was easily fooled with Google Image searches and Internet slang.

Overall, this software is strictly for parents who don't want to spend money on software and have pre-teens who are just starting to use the Internet. Even then, Parental Filter is free as well, and better, so there's really no sense in downloading and installing We-Blocker 2.0!



We-Blocker does not offer Task Manager disabling, but if you kill the process it just restarts! Bad blocking though

Summing It Up

All the software here are good or bad in different respects. There's no perfect software out there yet, and absolutely all of these were very, very disappointing in terms of analysing images.

CYBERSitter did the best in terms of filtering images, by forcing safe searches and seemingly checking ALT tags—according to the logs anyway. Also, I liked the way it just stops you from viewing a site without announcing its presence to your kids—many of whom will promptly search Google for ways to bypass software that's stopping them! I would recommend this as the software to buy if you want to protect your kids.

Parental Filter is very good, and in order to be secure, all you need to do is create a low-level access account for your kids so that they cannot install Firefox to bypass the software and use IE as the default browser. Since it doesn't cost you a rupee, and is almost as good as CYBERSitter, everyone who doesn't want to spend or cannot afford CYBERSitter should install this very useful software. Just make sure you choose to display the icon on your Taskbar before you choose to install it as a Windows Service. And do not select the "Don't show password dialog. Invisible login" option unless you know what you're doing!

Apart from these two, another good choice is CyberPatrol, which came in third! ■

agent001@thinkdigit.com